India. But he found the American military approach—and continued bombing in the midst of peace efforts that only made Beijing more intransigent—to be "outrageous." On balance, he blamed American policy in the Far East, which had "come in the way of a peace effort."[244]

India was not, however, only frustrated with the US. Panikkar, for example, became so annoyed with the lack of Chinese action on American prisoners that he dropped his opposition to public pleas.[245] Like their US counterparts, Bajpai and other Indian officials also questioned whether China was feeding India wrong or exaggerated information to pressure the US into negotiations on Chinese terms.[246] Furthermore, China kept vacillating about its preferred policy options. After Beijing's July 1952 U-turn, Nehru expressed "extreme displeasure and embarrassment" internally.[247] He lamented, "The situation at the China end is more difficult than we have imagined."[248] Nehru insisted that any future Chinese proposals should be conveyed in writing rather than just verbally.[249] He was again disappointed when Beijing rejected another Indian proposal in November 1952. Moreover, China criticized India's attempts to be the "voice of Asia" and dismissed it as a tool of the US. Nehru wondered if these rejections stemmed from Moscow's influence or a belief that India had leaned too much toward the UN/US side.[250]

Despite concerns, Delhi believed its mediatory role and neutrality made it somewhat useful—and therefore important—to Beijing. As long as this was the case, Bajpai noted that China would not trouble India. Rather, it had given India assurances regarding the Sino-Indian border, with Zhou indicating that China "had no intention [of] making claims to or raising questions about boundary" and asserting that China wanted "cultivation [of] friendship" with India and Burma.[251] Acheson, too, observed that China was not taking military action against Burma since it would upset India at a time when it was important for Beijing to stay on Delhi's good side.[252] But in summer 1952, when China had reneged on commitments to India on Korea, Nehru's concern about broader implications was evident—against Panikkar's advice, he thought India should explicitly raise the boundary issue with China.[253] Even beyond China, Krishna Menon believed that India's role as intermediary increased its global influence and importance.[254]

American officials had mixed feelings about the Indian role. Henderson, for example, believed India could be an "ameliorating influence" on